

***An Inconvenient Truth***, a 2006 documentary on climate change by former US Vice President Al Gore, aimed to educate the public on the causes and effects of climate change.

**"… human beings are now carrying out a large-scale geophysical experiment of a kind that could not have happened in the past…"**

**Roger Revelle and Hans Suess**

# The Kyoto plan

Nine years after the creation of the IPCC, in 1997, UN members signed the Kyoto Protocol, which sought to improve regulation of global carbon emissions. This protocol was the first agreement among nations to mandate country-by-country reductions in greenhouse gas emissions, aiming to reduce them to levels that would stop humans from negatively impacting the world's ecosystems.

Although it was signed in 1997, the Kyoto Protocol did not take effect until 2005. At the end of the first commitment period in 2012, all signatory nations had achieved their target reduction except for Canada, which withdrew from the protocol because it could not meet its targets. Australia also failed to reduce emissions, but during the initial period, the country's target was set as an 8 percent increase.